Title:

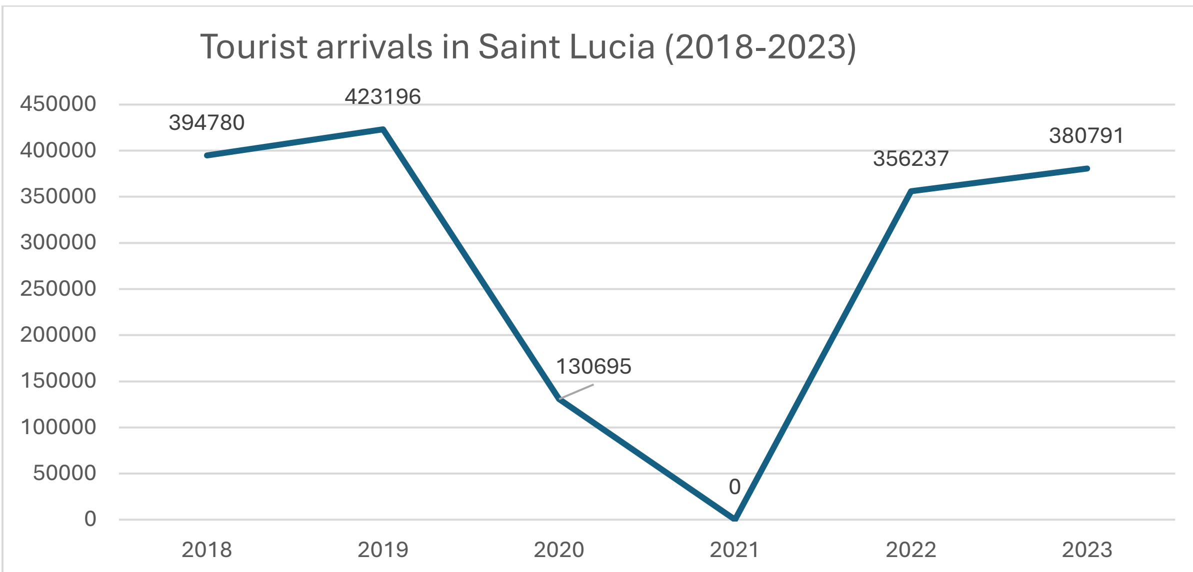
Analysis of Tourist Arrivals by Country of Residence in Saint Lucia (2018-2023)

Introduction:

Tourism is a key sector in Saint Lucia’s economy, contributing significantly to employment, foreign exchange earnings, and overall economic growth. This report analyses tourist arrivals by country of residence over the period 2018 to 2023, using data from the Central Statistical Office of Saint Lucia. The aim of the analysis is to identify key trends in total arrivals, examine the contribution of major source markets and assess the impact of external shocks such as the COVID-19 pandemic on tourism performance. The findings provide insight into the structure, resilience, and recovery patterns of the tourism sector over time.

Findings and Analysis:

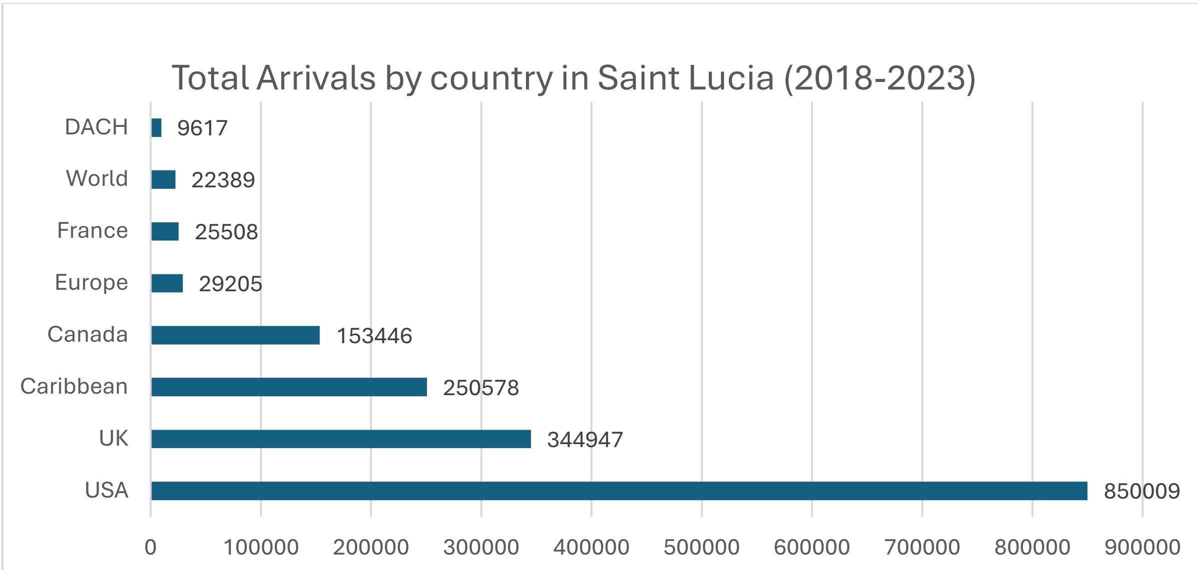
Chart 1: Total Tourist arrivals in Saint Lucia (2018-2023)



Interpretation:

Tourist arrivals increased from 394780 in 2018 to a peak 423736 in 2019, before declining sharply to 130,695 in 2020. This represents a significant contraction likely associated with global travel restrictions during the COVID-19 pandemic.

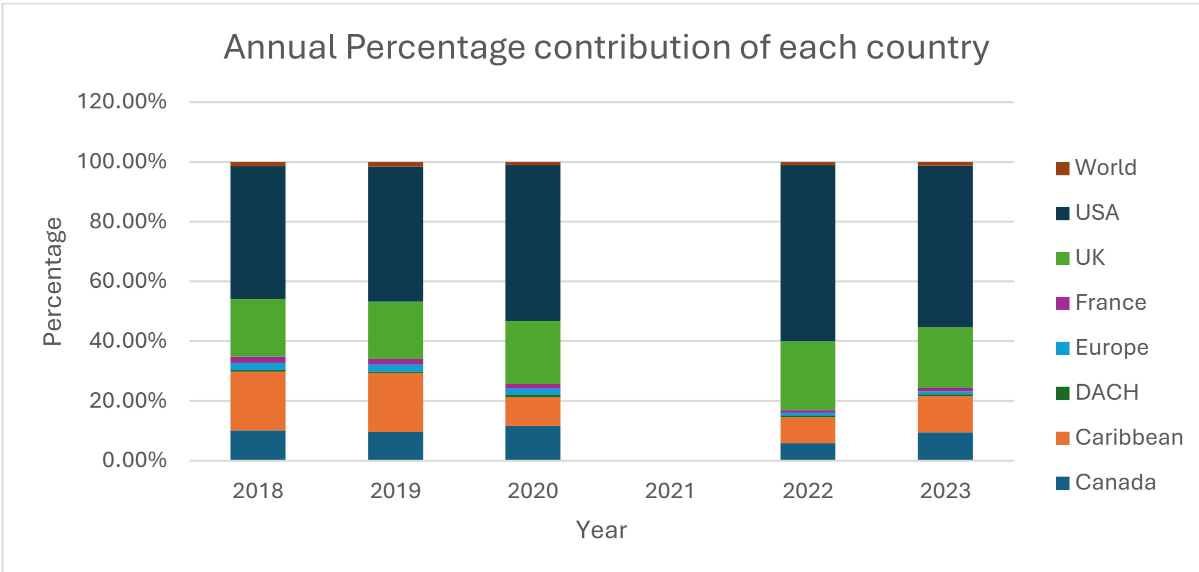
Chart 2: Total Arrivals in Saint Lucia (2018-2023)



Interpretation:

The United States is the largest source market for arrivals in Saint Lucia over the period 2018 to 2023. Other significant markets include the United Kingdom, Canada and the Caribbean; however, their contributions are considerably smaller, with the second highest contributor being more than half the US. This indicates a high level of independence on the United States as the primary source of tourists.

Chart 3: Market share of Tourist Arrival by Country (2018-2023)



Interpretation:

The market share analysis reveals that the United States dominates tourist arrivals in Saint Lucia across all years, with its share increasing noticeably during the post-2020 recovery period. This suggests that the recovery of the tourism sector has been disproportionately driven by the US market. meanwhile other key markets like the United Kingdom and the Caribbean maintain relatively smaller and more stable shares. This pattern indicates a growing concentration of tourism demand, which may heighten the sector's vulnerability to external shocks affecting the primary market.

Recommendations:

1. Diversify source markets:
   Saint Lucia should expand its tourism base beyond the United States to reduce dependency on a single market.
   This can be achieved through targeted marketing campaigns and partnerships with airlines and travel agencies in Europe and emerging markets

2. Strengthen regional tourism:
   Greater emphasis should be placed on attracting visitors from the Caribbean region to improve resilience during global disruptions.
   This may include offering regional travel incentives, promoting short stay packages, and improving inter-island transportation connectivity.

3. Improve tourism resilience:
   The significant decline in 2020 highlights the need for strategies to better withstand external shocks.
   Developing contingency plans, investing in digital tourism platforms, and encouraging domestic tourism can help maintain activity during crises.

4. Enhance marketing strategies:
   Expanding and refining marketing efforts can help attract a more diverse range of visitors.
   Utilizing data-driven marketing, social media campaigns and collaborations with international tourism can increase global visibility.

Conclusion:

The analysis of arrivals in Saint Lucia from 2018 to 2023 reveals a clear pattern of growth, disruption, and recovery. The sector experienced steady growth up to 2019, followed by a severe decline in 2020 due to the COVID-19 pandemic. Unfortunately, the Statistical Office had no data available for 2021, but it is safe to assume that the pandemic kept the value to a minimum. Although a strong recovery is evident in subsequent years, total arrivals in 2023 did not fully return to pre-pandemic levels. The United States is the dominant source market, contributing the largest share of tourist arrivals across all years. This concentration, while beneficial during periods of strong demand, also exposes the sector to external risks. Overall, the tourism industry demonstrates resilience but continues to face challenges related to market diversification and full post-pandemic recovery. It should be noted that the analysis is limited to data up to 2023, as official figures for 2024 and 2025 were not yet published.